

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp *****

TUESDAY, DECEMBER 10, 2024 ~ VOL. CCLXXXIV NO. 137

WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Omnicom will acquire** Interpublic in a deal that will create the world's largest advertising business, the companies confirmed. **A1**
- ◆ **China announced an** anti-trust probe into Nvidia a week after the U.S. tightened controls on Beijing's access to high-end semiconductors. **A1**
- ◆ **U.S. stocks slipped**, hurt in part by declines in Nvidia shares after China's probe became public. The S&P 500 and Nasdaq both fell 0.6% and the Dow dropped 0.5%. **B11**
- ◆ **Activist investor** Barington has built a position in Macy's and is pushing the department-store operator to make changes to boost its slumping stock. **B1**
- ◆ **Jeep maker Stellantis** shuffled its executive ranks in North America, a trouble spot that contributed to the recent departure of Chief Executive Carlos Tavares. **B1**
- ◆ **Warner Bros. Discovery** completed a cable distribution deal with Comcast, locking in higher fees for its networks and resolving a legal battle over a new "Harry Potter" TV series. **B1**
- ◆ **VW workers went on** strike for the second time this month as employee representatives and management enter a fourth round of talks over deep cost-cutting at the carmaker. **B3**
- ◆ **Vivendi shareholders** approved a breakup of the France-based conglomerate and the listing of its core business on the stock market. **B3**
- ◆ **A Nevada probate** commissioner rejected Rupert Murdoch's attempt to give control of his media assets to his oldest son when he dies, rather than dividing it among four children. **B3**

World-Wide

- ◆ **A suspect in the killing** of a UnitedHealth executive was arrested and charged with murder after being spotted at a McDonald's in Pennsylvania following a nearly weeklong manhunt. **A1**
- ◆ **Israel said it destroyed** chemical and other weapons caches in Syria and seized areas along the countries' shared border, as it seeks to keep weapons out of the hands of Sunni Islamist rebels. **A1**
- ◆ **Syrians freed hundreds** of men from a notorious prison north of Damascus and searches were made for what families suspect are secret cells holding other inmates. **A1**
- ◆ **More than 180 people** were killed in Haiti's capital as a warlord ordered the slaying of elderly slum residents he suspected of giving his son a severe illness through witchcraft. **A10**
- ◆ **Daniel Penny** was acquitted of a homicide charge for choking a homeless man on a New York City subway car in a case that prompted a national debate over the line between self-defense and vigilantism. **A3**
- ◆ **Trump talked up** his daughter-in-law Lara Trump for the Senate seat in Florida being vacated by Marco Rubio in a conversation with Gov. DeSantis, people familiar with the discussion said. **A6**
- ◆ **Canada's leader said** Ottawa would retaliate with its own set of tariffs should Trump follow through on his pledge to slap a 25% levy on imports from Canada. **A6**
- ◆ **The National Weather Service** warned of high fire risk for Los Angeles and Ventura counties, anticipating the return of Santa Ana winds. **A2**

CONTENTS	
Markets & Finance	B11
Arts in Review	A14
BusinessFinance	B2610
Business News	B3
Crossword	A14
Heard on Street	B12
Market Data	B7
Opinion	A17-19
Personal Journal	A12-13
Sports	A16
Technology	B4
U.S. News	A2-6
World News	A8-10



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Suspect Charged With CEO's Killing

Ivy League graduate had a gun, silencer and fake ID when arrested, officials say

A suspect in the killing of UnitedHealth executive Brian Thompson was arrested Monday after being spotted at a Pennsylvania McDonald's following a nearly weeklong manhunt.

Police identified the suspect in the New York ambush shooting as 26-year-old Luigi Mangione, a former tech

worker and Ivy League college graduate.

New York prosecutors charged Mangione with murder on Monday evening, according to court documents. New York and Pennsylvania have also charged him with felony weapons and forgery charges, among other offenses.

A McDonald's employee in Altoona, Pa., called the police after he was seen eating in the restaurant. Mangione was sitting, looking at a laptop when the police approached him, according to the Altoona police.

He was wearing a medical

By Kris Maher, Alyssa Lukpat and James Fanelli

mask that they asked him to lower, the officers said.

"We just didn't think twice about it. We knew that was our guy," said Tyler Frye, one of the two responding officers, at a news conference.

Mangione provided the officers with a New Jersey driver's license bearing the name Mark Rosario. Police said Mangione "became quiet and started to shake" when

they asked if he had been to New York recently. He gave his name as Luigi Mangione after police told him he was under official investigation. When asked why he gave a fake name, he replied, "I clearly shouldn't have."

During a search of his backpack, police said they found a pistol and silencer, both produced by 3-D printing. The pistol had a magazine with six 9-millimeter rounds inside.

Please turn to page A2

◆ **Ivy Leaguer wrote on** revolution, health..... **A2**



Luigi Mangione in a holding cell after his arrest Monday.



Efforts to find hidden cells in the notorious Saydnaya prison, from which hundreds had already been freed, continued Monday.

Syrians Scour Prisons for Loved Ones

By ISABEL COLES

As hundreds emerged from a prison near Damascus dubbed the "human slaughterhouse," Rim Turkmani waited anxiously, hoping a cousin detained eight years ago would be among the prisoners who emerged haggard but joyful.

"We've heard nothing about him since, except that he is held at Saydnaya prison," she said of her cousin Abdullah, just 18 when he was

imprisoned for participating in the uprising against then-President Bashar al-Assad.

Assad's downfall has provided hope for the families of tens of thousands of Syrians who disappeared into the labyrinth of the security apparatus. Hundreds of men were freed from the notorious Saydnaya prison, north of the capital, after Syrians stormed it hours before Assad fled the country early Sunday.

Footage from inside the

prison showed armed men shooting through locks and gaunt detainees emerging. "Ten years in prison!" cried one man in a video provided by the Association of Detainees and Missing in Saydnaya Prison. Another video showed a wall of screens that enabled guards to watch over the prisoners in their cells.

Some relatives were convinced that more prisoners remained trapped in hidden subterranean cells. The Syrian

Civil Defense, an independent rescue organization also known as the White Helmets, deployed wall-breaching specialists, iron-door-opening crews and trained dog units to search. The group also enlisted guides familiar with the layout of the prison, while the rebel military command called on soldiers who worked at the prison to come forward with passcodes to unlock the doors of underground cells.

Please turn to page A8

Israel Puts Troops Into Syria, Hits Arms Stockpiles

TEL AVIV—Israel said it had destroyed chemical and other weapons caches in Syria and seized areas along the countries' shared border, taking advantage of a power vacuum in Syria as it seeks to keep weapons out of the hands of Sunni Islamist rebels.

By Anat Peled, Carrie Keller-Lynn and Dov Lieber

The moves garnered condemnations from some Arab countries, saying they undermined Syria's territorial integrity. Israel said it had seized a demilitarized buffer zone, which was established 50 years ago under a cease-fire deal, and had ordered forces to temporarily take over abandoned Syrian army positions beyond it.

Israel has been more hawkish about protecting its borders since last year's Hamas-led Oct. 7 attack. Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said the move was "to ensure that no hostile force embeds itself right next door to the border of Israel."

Israeli military engineers

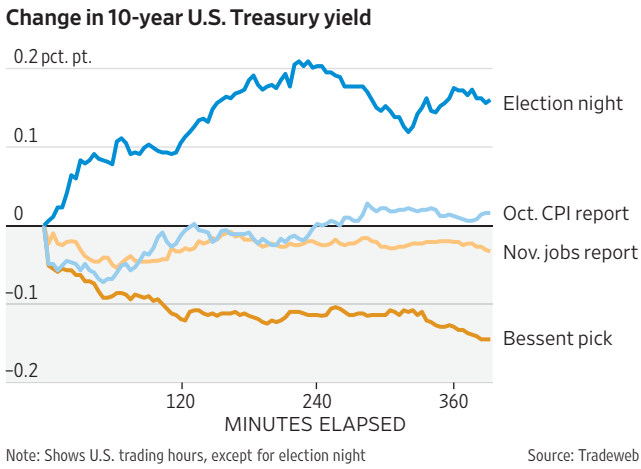
Please turn to page A9

◆ **Assad's fall is historic blow** to Iran..... **A8**

◆ **U.S. renews push to find** missing American Tice... **A8**

Yields Swing on Election

Big moves in Treasury yields lately have been sparked by the November election results and by President-elect Donald Trump's pick of Scott Bessent as Treasury secretary. **B1**



The Two Most Dreaded Words In a Text Conversation

The phrase 'call me' could mean anything from an emergency to a forgotten password

By ANN-MARIE ALCÁNTARA

In October, Josh Seefried received a text he's gotten many, many times before. "Call me," an older family member wrote.

It contained no punctuation and didn't explain whether the request was an emergency or nothing to worry about. Did someone die, or did the family member just need help logging into Netflix?

"It creates a sense of urgency where it's not needed," says Seefried, a 39-year-old

communications manager who lives in Annapolis, Md. It turned out the family member wanted to chat about Christmas plans.

The text annoyed him so much that Seefried posted about the exchange on X, where it received more than 32,000 likes and 5,000 comments with people commiserating.

He isn't alone in his anguish. For years, people have complained about receiving "call me" texts from parents.

Please turn to page A13

Omnicom Agrees to Acquire Interpublic in \$13 Billion Deal

By SUZANNE VRANICA AND GARETH VIPERS

Omnicom Group will acquire Interpublic Group in a deal that will create the world's largest advertising business, the companies confirmed on Monday.

A combined entity would have net revenue of more than \$20 billion, based on 2023 figures for each company, and include storied ad agencies such as TBWA Worldwide and McCann Worldgroup. Their client rosters include Amazon,

AT&T, PepsiCo, Unilever and Volkswagen.

The Wall Street Journal reported on Sunday that the companies were in advanced merger talks. The stock deal values Interpublic at more than \$13 billion.

It is intended to help the combined company better compete with tech behemoths such as Google and Meta Platforms, which have emerged as dominant forces in the advertising business and stand to push even further into Madison Avenue's territory with

the rise of generative AI. This technology is expected to enable them to handle more of the creative development for brands—a cornerstone of advertising agencies.

The deal "allows us to take control of our own future, rather than wait for technology to impact it in ways that you can't anticipate today," Omnicom Chairman and Chief Executive John Wren said during a call with investors.

Wren said Omnicom and Interpublic "share highly com-

Please turn to page A6

INSIDE



China Probes Nvidia Over Antitrust Claims

By RAFFAELE HUANG AND LIZA LIN

SINGAPORE—Beijing fired its latest salvo in the U.S.-China semiconductor wars by announcing an antitrust probe into U.S. chip juggernaut Nvidia, a week after Washington stepped up controls on China's access to high-end semiconductors.

Industry watchers said the move was aimed at sending a message that China won't stand by quietly when targeted by trade and technology sanctions—a message with particular relevance as Donald Trump prepares to assume the presidency in January.

Shares of Nvidia, which makes the bulk of the cutting-edge chips that power artificial-intelligence servers, closed down 2.6% on Monday.

The company's China revenue totaled \$13.5 billion in the past four quarters, accounting for 12% of its global total. That proportion has shrunk because U.S. sanctions restricted Nvidia from selling its most-advanced chips to Chinese customers.

A Nvidia spokesman said customers are free to choose which chips they use, and that the company wins on the merit of its products. "We are happy to answer any questions regulators may have

Please turn to page A4